



A JOURNALIST documents damage at a mosque after strikes on Sharif University in Tehran on Tuesday. ATTA KENARE AFP/Getty Images

Bass lowers goal for LAPD staffing

Facing fiscal and political challenges, mayor now wants to stop it from shrinking.

By LIBOR JANY

When she ran for mayor four years ago, Karen Bass said she wanted to regrow the Los Angeles Police Department to the 9,500-officer force it was before the ranks began to shrink. Now up for reelection — and facing a budget crunch — Bass says her plan has shifted.

The aim going forward, she told The Times in a recent interview, is to simply stop the department from getting smaller.

As of this week, the department had 8,677 sworn personnel — the lowest total in nearly a quarter-century. Even after efforts under Bass to streamline hiring and boost recruitment, some officials are concerned there won't be enough new cops to replace those projected to leave or retire in the coming years.

"My goal changed, unfortunately," Bass said. "I do hope that one day we get to the expansion, but we are not there now."

A Bass spokesperson said after the interview that the mayor remains committed to reaching the 9,500-officer benchmark in the long run, but did not provide a timeline for getting there.

On April 20, Bass will release her spending plan for the upcoming fiscal year, which starts on July 1. She and the City Council will spend the coming months working out how to balance the city's books in a way that avoids deep cuts to other services and the layoffs of city employees. A projection by the city administrative officer estimates the city's budget deficit to be "several hundred million."

Bass said she had spent years addressing a years-old administrative bottleneck within the city's personnel department, which runs the background process for police hires.

The efforts were targeted "at every level: at the top, as well as internal to the department," Bass said. "At least the impediments that kept us from retaining recruits, to get them in the academy, that has changed."

The mayor called the old hiring process "archaic" and said similar issues exist with other city departments. At the LAPD, she said, "We expanded recruitment and had a record number of

[See LAPD, A8]

Iranian hackers target key U.S. infrastructure

Intelligence agencies warn companies of escalating campaigns, presumed retaliation for Trump's threats

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — U.S. intelligence agencies are "urgently warning" private-sector companies nationwide that Iranian actors are conducting cyber operations targeting critical U.S. infrastructure, a campaign that has already caused disruptions, according to a government notice.

The activity comes as President Trump threatened Iran's infrastructure, particularly its bridges and power plants.

Iran's attack targeted products by Rockwell Automation's Allen-Bradley, one of the most widely used industrial automation

brands, according to the notice, which was first reported Tuesday by The Times. The advisory said that cyber actors affiliated with Iran were exploiting "programmable logic controllers across U.S. critical infrastructure."

Tehran's targeting campaigns against U.S. organizations "have recently escalated, likely in response to hostilities between Iran and the United States and Israel," the notice added.

The advisory was issued Tuesday jointly by the FBI, the Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency, the National Security Agency, the Environmental Protection Agency, the Department of Energy and Cy-

ber Command.

In its own notice, the EPA warned that Iran's cyberattack had already disrupted "commonly used operational technology at drinking water and wastewater systems," and that the federal government is "diligently working to ensure that Americans can rely on clean and safe water."

"Cyberattacks on drinking water and wastewater systems directly threaten public health and community resilience," Jeffrey A. Hall, the EPA's assistant administrator for enforcement and compliance assurance, said in a statement. "A single breach can disrupt treatment or introduce contami-

[See Cyberattacks, A4]

Trump shelves strike after Iran agrees to truce

President had threatened to wipe out 'whole civilization.' Tehran says 2-week pause won't end war.

By ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — The United States and Iran reached an eleventh-hour ceasefire deal on Tuesday night, pausing for two weeks the threat of military strikes that President Trump had warned would wipe out a "whole civilization" unless Tehran agreed to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

The agreement, announced by Trump in a social media post a little more than an hour before the 5 p.m. PDT deadline, came shortly after Pakistan, a mediator in the peace talks, asked Trump to give more time for diplomacy.

Trump said the agreement was "subject to the Islamic Republic of Iran agreeing to the COMPLETE, IMMEDIATE, and SAFE OPENING of the Strait of Hormuz."

"This will be a double sided CEASEFIRE!" Trump said. "The reason for doing so is that we have already met and exceeded all Military objectives, and are very far along with a definitive Agreement concerning Longterm PEACE with Iran, and PEACE in the Middle East."

Iran's Supreme National Security Council said in a statement that it had accepted the terms of the two-week ceasefire but empha-



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sized that "this does not signify the termination of the war."

"Our hands remain upon the trigger, and should the slightest error be committed by the enemy, it shall be met with full force," according to the statement.

The full details of the agreement were not immediately made public, but Trump said that "almost all of the various points of past contention have been agreed to between the United States and Iran."

The agreement came hours after Trump warned on social media that a "whole civilization will die" Tuesday night if Iran does not meet his deadline to fully reopen the key strait, escalating tensions as diplomatic talks to end the war continue.

"A whole civilization will die tonight, never to be brought back again," Trump wrote Tuesday morning on his social media website. "I don't want that to happen, but it probably will."

Trump has a history of issuing deadlines in diplomatic standoffs, only to quietly walk them back when they pass without resolution. But his warning Tuesday stood apart as it invoked apocalyptic language that goes well beyond his previous ultimatums.

Leading up to the deadline, the White House provided few details on where negotiations stood. But on Tuesday afternoon, Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, whose country is helping mediate peace talks, asked Trump to give

[See Iran, A4]

Family films are saving the box office

A \$191-million opening for 'Super Mario' shows PG movies continue to dominate.

By SAMANTHA MASUNAGA

It was another big weekend for family films, as "The Super Mario Galaxy Movie" smashed the box office with a domestic haul of \$190.8 million.

That five-day total marked the biggest opening weekend in the U.S. and Canada so far this year. Globally, the film from Universal Pictures, Nintendo and Illumination made \$372.6 million — the highest debut for a U.S. film this year.

"It was a film for all audi-



THE STEWART OF NY Getty Images

"THE SUPER Mario Galaxy Movie," a Universal Pictures executive said, was "a film for all audiences."

ences," said Jim Orr, president of domestic distribution at Universal Pictures. "You don't have to be a Nintendo insider. It really appealed to everybody."

The opening weekend success of "Super Mario Galaxy" wasn't just good news for Universal Pictures. It is yet another auspicious sign of the continued dominance of family films in cinemas.

In each of the last two years, the top domestic movie was a PG-rated film — in 2024, Walt Disney Co. and Pixar's "Inside Out 2" reigned supreme, while Warner Bros. Pictures' "A Minecraft Movie" came out on top in 2025 (Disney's "Zootopia 2," released in late 2025, ended up edging the domestic revenues for "A Minecraft Movie" in a strong

[See Box office, A12]

LAUSD tells parents to brace for strike

By HOWARD BLUME

Los Angeles schools are days away from a historic employee walkout — which for the first time would involve three major unions representing teachers, most nonteaching staff and school administrators, including principals and assistant principals.

If a strike unfolds on Tuesday with the three unions — or even two of the three — it would be impossible to keep all campuses open, the district confirmed Monday, upending the education of some 390,000 students and their families' workday routines.

Parents would scramble for child-care options and an alternative for weekday breakfasts and lunches. Depending on how long a po-

tential strike lasted, important state testing could be disrupted, as could student plans to take college admissions assessments, such as the SAT and Advanced Placement exams.

The Los Angeles Unified School District wants families to plan ahead.

"Families should prepare now by ensuring their child can access learning through Schoology," which is the district's online learning system, according to a statement provided in response to questions from The Times. Parents also should make sure their child "has a working device and internet connection."

Parents too should identify "local food distribution sites and childcare options. They should also make sure their contact information is

[See LAUSD, A7]

'Gladiator fight' cases are collapsing

Charges have been dropped against many probation officers in L.A. County juvenile halls. CALIFORNIA, B1

Popcorn buckets butter up buyers

Struggling movie theaters are capitalizing on the craze of collectible containers to up fans' spending. BUSINESS, A10

Blue Jays fans pour the boos out

They take great pride in jumping on Dodgers, but players flip the script in a 14-2 rout, Bill Shaikin writes. SPORTS, B10

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 76/58. B6

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MARIAH TAUGER L.A. Times

FANS go wild at Tame Impala's headlining set.

Down Coachella's memory lane

Before its 25th edition, revisit iconic moments from the desert experiment turned phenomenon. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Markets A11
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A push to tax empty homes

San Diego voters will consider a levy to raise revenue and boost housing market.

By GRACE TOOHEY

San Diego is one of the nation's hottest housing markets, with average home prices hovering around \$1 million and rents for a one-bedroom apartment topping \$2,000 a month.

Yet city officials estimate that more than 5,000 properties sit empty most of the year, which some advocates argue worsens the city's housing shortage and affordability crisis.

So California's second-largest city is set to take dramatic action.

In a few weeks, San Diego voters will decide whether to become the latest California municipality to tax vacant homes — a revenue bid that officials insist could raise millions and return some empty residences to the housing market.

San Diego's independent budget analysis estimates that the tax, if it's passed by voters in June, would apply to about 5,000 empty homes and could raise up to \$24 million in its first year of implementation, depending on the extent of exemptions. That money can be used by officials to fund new affordable housing projects, and proponents hope the financial blow could discourage some owners from keeping their units empty.

Affordability "is a prob-

[See Tax, A8]